

Their efforts are in execution: they have training programmes at authorised training centres for products such as Smoke, Final Cut Pro, Maya, After Effects, and others. These are used for different purposes in post-production. At the end of the programme, candidates are awarded certificates by the companies (such as Autodesk, Avid, Apple, and Pinnacle), which are recognised as the certified students and instructors of their particular software.

"Today, a lot of work is done on the Smoke system, which has slowly started being identified as an industry standard for compositing and editing. I feel this course on Smoke has helped me enhance my career prospects," says Tilak Chari, a Smoke Artist employed with Famous Studios, and one of those who passed out in the first batch of the Autodesk Smoke course in collaboration with Zee Institute of Media Arts.

Opportunities In India

As in many other areas, a fresher could face a chicken-and-egg situation: post-production houses, TV channels, and advertising agencies all want to hire those with experience. But how does one get experience without having gotten a job in the first place? However, there seems to be not too much cause for worry,



The main challenge for professionals in this industry is to create a niche and get their work noticed. Only that can mark the beginning of a successful career"

Atul Vohra
Country head -
Domestic Retail
Arena Multimedia

because right now, opportunities in the field are unlimited. The television and film industries want to absorb young, talented freshers willing to work hard and acquire knowledge of the applicable technologies. Demand exceeds supply here.

The Indian entertainment industry has been proving its potential with movies such as *Black*, *Wah! Life Ho To Aisi*, *Rang De Basanti* and others, using international-standard post-production facilities.

"Today, many film makers and TV programme producers are outsourcing their work to production houses involved exclusively in post-production. There is plenty of work available in the market, but the industry is facing a shortage of talented and creative professionals," says Mohan Krishnan, head of corporate communications, Prasad EFX, a pre- and post-production house specialising in Vfx.

The Figures

The Indian media and entertainment industry is expected to grow at a compound annual growth rate of 19 per cent to reach Rs 83,740 crore by 2010 from Rs 35,300 crore at present, according to a 2005 annual report by FICCI (Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry) and PriceWaterhouseCoopers on the industry.

According to NASSCOM (the National Association of Software and Services Companies), post-production work of US and European film studios being outsourced to India could grow to an amazing Rs 44,650 crore by 2009.

Summing It Up

The post-production industry is now incorporating the infrastructure to meet international standards. With the increase in expectations from clients and filmmakers, efforts are being applied for better output. The availability here of creative, skilled, English-speaking professionals, as well as cheaper ways to generate special effects with the use of the latest equipment and facilities has attracted many clients to outsource their post-production work from the US and Europe.

The process of post-production is getting broader and more compartmentalised. The need and opportunities for freshers and professionals will always be there. Unleash your latent creativity on-screen—with a little help from technology—and the world can be yours! ■

samir_makwana@thinkdigit.com

The Long And Winding Road

Placements are possible at Television Channels, Post-Production Houses, Advertising Agencies, and NGOs. You could also freelance or even start a post-production house!

A Broad Categories Of Career Profiles

Post Production Executive/Project Manager: Plans, handles and co-ordinates every activity of post-production

Video Editor/Assistant Editors: Editing of footage, cutting of scenes, making a final logical sequence of the footage

Visual Mixer (Online Editor): Receives a signal from the director to cut from one picture source to another, producing a smooth sequence of images.

Visual Effects Supervisor: A person with the experience and knowledge to generate visual graphics. He should also be able to work with natural phenomena like smoke, fire, flames, and particles

Graphics Designer: Creates, handles and co-ordinates still and motion graphics generation from the team of animators, modellers, designers, and such

Visualiser: An artist who conceptualises or visualises a particular scene or shot of a movie / program and pens it down in the form of words and storyboards and/or sketches

Special Effects Artist: An artist who plans or arranges for special-effect stunts and scenes

Compositor: Adds multiple layers and combines various elements such as live footage, still action, animation, and so on



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